DARK FORGE — A DEADLANDS: THE WEIRD WEST CAMPAIGN

Posse Primer

Twenty-four ways to die in the Weird West — and how to choose yours

This booklet is for players new to Deadlands. It explains the setting in a page, the dice in another, and then walks through every one of the 24 archetypes in the Deadlands core book and Weird West Companion: who they are, what they're good at, and what kind of player will enjoy them. Pick one you like and your Marshal will drop a ready-to-play version into Foundry for you to rename and make your own.

The Weird West in one page

It's 1884, but not the 1884 from the history books. In 1863 something called **the Reckoning** cracked the wall between our world and the Hunting Grounds, the spirit realm. Fear leaked in, and fear feeds the things that followed it: the **Reckoners**, four beings who want the whole world to feel the way a graveyard feels at midnight. Their servants, the **manitous**, ride in the bodies of the dead, whisper to inventors, and gamble with card sharps for the right to grant a little power.

The Civil War never properly ended; the **Union** and the **Confederacy** sit in a cold stalemate. California shattered into the **Great Maze**, a flooded labyrinth of canyons where **ghost rock** was found — a mineral that burns hotter than coal and screams while it does. Ghost rock powers steam wagons, gatling pistols, and worse, and the **Rail Barons** are at war over it. The Sioux Nations and the Coyote Confederation have reclaimed their lands and hold them. The **Agency** (Union) and the **Texas Rangers** (Confederate) quietly hunt monsters and bury the evidence, because if ordinary folks knew what was out there, the fear would feed the Reckoners more.

Your posse is a handful of people who have seen behind the curtain. Some of you were law before you learned the truth; some of you are the truth — dead men walking, witches, card-slinging sorcerers. You'll ride into towns with a **Fear Level**, face things that make Vigor rolls matter, and try to leave each place a little less afraid than you found it.

Savage Worlds in one page

Dice are your skills. Every Attribute and Skill is a die type: d4 (bad), d6 (average), d8 (good), d10 (great), d12 (legendary). To do something, roll that die; a **4** or better succeeds, and every 4 above that is a **Raise** that makes it better.

You're a Wild Card. Player heroes also roll a **Wild Die** (d6) with every Trait roll and keep the better result. Any die that rolls its maximum **Aces**: roll again and add. A d4 can beat a d12 on a lucky day.

Bennies are poker chips you spend to reroll a Trait roll, to **Soak** damage, or to shake off being Shaken. You start each session with three; good roleplay, bad luck, and Tale-Tellers earn more.

Combat. Initiative is dealt from a deck of cards each round. To hit in melee you need the target's **Parry**; at range you need 4. Damage against **Toughness**: beat it and the target is **Shaken** (rattled, can't act); each Raise is a **Wound**. Heroes take three Wounds before they're Incapacitated. Extras (mooks) go down in one.

Edges and Hindrances. Edges are the special abilities that define your hero. Hindrances are flaws you took on purpose — Majors hurt, Minors nag — and they bought you the points for extra Edges. Play them up; the Marshal hands out Bennies for it.

Powers. Casters have Power Points and an Arcane Skill (Faith, Spellcasting, Weird Science, Focus). Roll the skill, spend the points, hope nothing goes wrong. In Deadlands something often goes wrong.

What's an archetype?

An archetype is a complete, legal starting hero built on the same budget every new character gets: five Attribute points, twelve Skill points, a free Edge for being human, and up to four points of Hindrances traded in for extra Edges and skills. You can play one exactly as written, rename it and change the look, or treat it as a starting point and swap a few things with your Marshal. Nothing here is locked in.

Roles in a posse

Savage Worlds has no classes, but a posse still wants a mix. Each archetype below is tagged with the role it fills best. Three to five players should try to cover at least a **Front Line**, a **Healer** or caster, and a **Face** or **Brains**; the rest is taste.

Front Line	Takes hits and holds the door. High Parry or Toughness, strong Fighting.	*Harrowed, Territorial Ranger, Warrior, US Marshal, Chi Master, Cowgirl*
Gunhand	Puts the most lead downrange. Shooting d8 plus damage-boosting Edges.	*Gunslinger, Bounty Hunter, Vaquero*
Arcane	Casts. Damage, control, or buffs, with a Deadlands twist and a Deadlands risk.	*Huckster, Hexslinger, Mad Scientist, Metal Mage, Shaman, Witch*
Healer	Keeps everyone standing, by miracle or by medicine.	*Blessed, Sawbones, Medicine Woman, Voodooist*
Face	Talks the posse into and out of trouble. Persuasion, Taunt, contacts.	*Saloon Gal, Muckraker*
Scout	Sees it first. Notice, Stealth, Survival, and a rifle.	*Native Scout, Explorer*
Brains	Finds the lead and knows what you're fighting.	*Agent, Explorer, Muckraker*

The Arcane Backgrounds

Magic in Deadlands always has a price. Here's what each flavor costs:

Blessed	**Faith.** Miracles from a higher power. No backlash from the magic itself, but sin against your faith and your powers fade until you atone.
Huckster / Hexslinger	**Spellcasting.** Hexes drawn from Hoyle's cipher, powered by gambling with manitous. You can **Deal with the Devil** for a huge boost — draw a poker hand; a good hand is great, a bad one hurts.
Mad Scientist / Metal Mage	**Weird Science.** Powers live in ghost-rock devices that others can borrow. Devices **malfunction** on a bad roll, and the whispers slowly erode your sanity.
Shaman / Medicine Woman	**Faith.** Favors from nature spirits, earned by keeping the old ways and performing rituals. Break the oath and the spirits stop answering.
Chi Master	**Focus.** Inner energy channelled through body and discipline. The least flashy and the least risky; powers are personal buffs and strikes.
Voodooist / Witch	**Faith / Spellcasting.** Companion traditions: loa spirits channelled through a talisman, or old-world witchcraft with a familiar. Each has its own taboo.
Harrowed	Not a caster — a dead hero brought back by a manitou. Immense durability, and a demon inside you that fights for **Dominion** over your body.



FRONT LINE

Chi Master

Martial artist and dodger

"Your fists are faster than their trigger fingers."

You came west with the railroad crews or across the Pacific on your own and brought a tradition the West has never seen: focus, discipline, and the ability to turn the body's own energy into something supernatural. Folks underestimate you right up until the moment they don't.

AT THE TABLE

A melee skirmisher who is hard to hit. **Martial Artist** makes your unarmed strikes Str+d4 and 'armed', so you're never at a disadvantage without a weapon. **Dodge** gives −2 to enemy ranged attacks against you, Parry 6 handles melee, and the **Deflection** power stacks more defense on top. **Smite** turns your fists into supernatural weapons and **Boost/Lower Trait** buffs you or a friend. Athletics d8 and Stealth d8 make you the best climber, jumper, and sneak in the posse. Downsides: no ranged option and **Code of Honor** as a Major — you fight fair even when they don't.

> **Pick this if** You want to close distance, dodge bullets, and punch monsters. Kung fu in the Weird West.

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d8	d6	d6	d6	d6

Parry 6 **Toughness** 5 **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS

Athletics d8, Fighting d8, Focus d8, Stealth d8
Healing d6, Notice d6

EDGES

Arcane Background (Chi Master), Dodge, Martial Artist, Feint

HINDRANCES

Code of Honor (Major), Outsider (Minor), Poverty (Minor)

POWERS

Boost/Lower Trait, Deflection, Smite

WEAPONS & GEAR

Fists Str+d4, Cloak, Satchel, Silk Fan



FRONT LINE

Cowgirl

Mounted all-rounder

"Give you a good horse and open country and there's nothing you can't handle."

You grew up working cattle and never found a reason to stop. You're more comfortable on horseback than on your own feet, you can rope anything that moves, and you'll fight when there's fighting to be done. You also take care of your own — animals and people alike.

AT THE TABLE

The most well-rounded of the non-casters. Vigor d8 and Spirit d8 give you Toughness 6 and strong resistance to fear and Shaken; Shooting d8 and Riding d8 make you deadly from the saddle. **Born in the Saddle** gives a free reroll on Riding and lets your horse run faster, **Quick Draw** means your gun is always out in time, and **Beast Bond** lets you spend Bennies for your horse. The lariat is a real combat tool for entangling targets. You can do a bit of everything; you're the best at nothing.

> **Pick this if** You want a sturdy, flexible character who's never useless and has a horse that matters.

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d8	d6	d8	d6	d8

Parry 5 **Toughness** 6 **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS

Riding d8, Shooting d8
Athletics d6, Common Knowledge d6, Fighting d6, Notice d6

EDGES

Beast Bond, Born in the Saddle, Quick Draw

HINDRANCES

Overconfident (Major), Loyal (Minor), Quirk (Minor)

WEAPONS & GEAR

Colt Peacemaker 2d6+1, Winchester '76 2d8, Lariat, Knife Str+d4, Chaps, Trusty Horse, Rope, bedroll, canteen



FRONT LINE

Harrowed

Undead tank

"You died. Something climbed back into the body with you. You're still arguing over who's driving."

You were killed — shot, hanged, drowned, it hardly matters — and a manitou crawled into your corpse and brought it back. Now you walk around with a demon riding shotgun in your skull, bargaining for control. Most folks can tell something's wrong with you. The ones who can't tend to learn the hard way.

AT THE TABLE

The hardest hero to put down. **Undead** gives +2 Toughness (8 total, best in the book), +2 to recover from Shaken, and immunity to disease, poison, and the need to breathe; called shots don't do extra damage to you. **Stitchin'** lets you heal wounds by willpower, **Supernatural Attribute** boosts your Agility, and **Killer Instinct** wins tied opposed rolls. All attributes d8 except Strength. The catch is the manitou: the **Harrowed** Edge comes with Dominion struggles where the demon can seize control, and your three Minor Hindrances (Mean, Ruthless, Vengeful) describe what you've become.

> **Pick this if** You want to stand in front, soak damage, and play a dark, morally complicated hero. Not for players who want a clean protagonist.

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d8	d8	d8	d6	d8

Parry 5 **Toughness** 8 **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS
Intimidation d8, Shooting d8
Athletics d6, Fighting d6, Notice d6, Riding d6, Stealth d6, Taunt d6

EDGES
Harrowed, Killer Instinct, Stitchin', Supernatural Attribute (Agility)

HINDRANCES
Mean (Minor), Ruthless (Minor), Vengeful (Minor)

SPECIAL
Undead

WEAPONS & GEAR
Colt Frontier 2d6+1, Knife Str+d4, Gun belt, Needle and thread



FRONT LINE

Territorial Ranger

Armored lawman and tank

"Desperadoes, scoundrels, and things most folks don't know exist. You handle all three."

The Territorial Rangers are the Confederacy's answer to the Agency: hard men and women with a badge, a shotgun, and a mandate to deal with whatever threatens the territories, natural or otherwise. You've buried partners. You've burned things that wouldn't stay dead. You carry dynamite, because sometimes that's what it takes.

AT THE TABLE

The posse's classic tank. Strength d8, Fighting d8, Shooting d8, Parry 6, and Toughness 8 thanks to the armored duster — tied for best in the book. **Double Tap** adds +1 to hit and damage with revolvers like your Thunderer, the shotgun is brutal up close, and the Bowie knife and dynamite round out a serious arsenal. **Guts** and **Brave** together make you nearly fearless, and the **Territorial Ranger** Edge gives legal authority and backing. **Obese** costs you Pace and running die; **Driven** is your obsession with the job.

> **Pick this if** You want to stand in the doorway, take the hits, and have a badge that lets you say 'official business.'

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d8	d6	d6	d8	d6

Parry 6 **Toughness** 8 (2) **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS
Fighting d8, Shooting d8
Athletics d6, Intimidation d6, Notice d6, Riding d6, Survival d6

EDGES
Brave, Double Tap, Guts, Territorial Ranger

HINDRANCES
Driven (Major), Obese (Minor), Stubborn (Minor)

WEAPONS & GEAR
Single-barrel shotgun, Colt Thunderer 2d6, Bowie knife Str+d4+1, Dynamite, Armored duster (light), Ranger badge, Horse



FRONT LINE

US Marshal

Steady lawman and leader

"Put down that hogleg and we'll settle this peaceful-like. Otherwise, you'll see how I got this job."

The federal badge means something, even out here. You're the posse's spine: the one who keeps a cool head, calls the shots, and doesn't flinch. You have a code and a vow and you keep both, even when it costs you.

AT THE TABLE

Durable and consistent. Vigor d8 gives Toughness 6, and **Iron Jaw** makes you harder to knock out and better at Soaking damage. **Level Headed** deals you two Action Cards each round and lets you keep the better one — you act early, every time. **Alertness** adds +2 to Notice. Shooting d8 with a Winchester '76 and Colt Frontier covers both ranges; Fighting d6, Intimidation d6, and Persuasion d6 mean you can also talk a situation down. The **US Marshal** Edge grants federal authority. **Code of Honor** and **Vow** as Majors define you: you play it straight.

> **Pick this if** You want to be the reliable leader who always acts first and never breaks, not the flashiest gun in the room.

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d6	d8	d6	d6	d8

Parry 5 **Toughness** 6 **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS

Shooting d8

Athletics d6, Common Knowledge d6, Fighting d6, Intimidation d6, Notice d6, Persuasion d6, Stealth d6

EDGES

Alertness, Iron Jaw, Level Headed, US Marshal

HINDRANCES

Code of Honor (Major), Vow (Major)

WEAPONS & GEAR

Winchester '76 2d8, Colt Frontier 2d6+1, US Marshal badge, Horse



FRONT LINE

Warrior

Melee powerhouse

"You charge without fear at your enemies, be they man or beast."

You fight for your people with lance and tomahawk and bow, and you are very good at it. The settlers' world baffles you and you want little of it, but the things rising from the land are everyone's enemy. You protect the weak and you do not run.

AT THE TABLE

The best melee combatant in the book. Strength d8, Fighting d8, and **Parry 8** — most enemies simply cannot hit you in close combat. **Frenzy** gives an extra Fighting attack every round, **Two-Fisted** lets you attack with a weapon in each hand without penalty, and **Don't Get 'Im Riled!** adds your Wounds to your damage — you hit harder as you get hurt. Native armor and a hair-pipe breastplate bring Toughness to 6. The bow gives you a quiet ranged option; Stealth d8 gets you close. **Old Ways Oath** means no guns or ghost-rock gadgets. **Guts** keeps you steady.

> **Pick this if** You want to be the melee monster who wades into a crowd and comes out the other side.

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d8	d6	d6	d8	d6

Parry 8 **Toughness** 6 (1) **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS

Fighting d8, Stealth d8

Athletics d6, Common Knowledge d6, Notice d6, Riding d6, Shooting d6

EDGES

Don't Get 'Im Riled!, Frenzy, Guts, Two-Fisted

HINDRANCES

Heroic (Major), Old Ways Oath (Minor), Outsider (Minor)

WEAPONS & GEAR

Lance Str+d6, Tomahawk Str+d6, Bow 2d6, Native armor, Hair-pipe breastplate, A good horse



GUNHAND

Bounty Hunter

Tracker and ranged killer

"Dead or alive. You lean toward dead; the paperwork's easier."

You read warrants like scripture and treat the frontier as one big manhunt. Towns tolerate you because you bring in the men the law can't catch; they don't like you, and you don't need them to. Somewhere along the way the bounties got stranger, and some of the posters now describe things that aren't men at all.

AT THE TABLE

A focused ranged damage dealer. Shooting d8 with the Winchester '73, and two Edges that spike damage: **Dead Shot** doubles your ranged damage when you're dealt a Joker, and **No Mercy** lets you spend a Benny to reroll a damage total. **Steady Hands** ignores the penalty for shooting from a moving horse. **Menacing** adds +2 to Intimidation and **Streetwise** helps you find people who don't want to be found; Survival d6 and Stealth d6 round out the tracker package. **Ruthless** and **Arrogant** as Majors make you a hard person to like — that's the roleplay hook.

> **Pick this if** You want to be the cold professional with the rifle, and you enjoy being the posse's hard edge.

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d8	d6	d6	d6	d6

Parry 5 **Toughness** 5 **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS

Shooting d8

Athletics d6, Fighting d6, Intimidation d6, Notice d6, Riding d6, Stealth d6, Survival d6

EDGES

Dead Shot, Menacing, No Mercy, Steady Hands, Streetwise

HINDRANCES

Arrogant (Major), Ruthless (Major)

WEAPONS & GEAR

Winchester '73 2d8-1, Colt Frontier 2d6+1, Bandolier, Stack of warrants



GUNHAND

Gunslinger

Two-gun duelist

"Two pistols, one reputation. Both loaded."

You've made your living and your name with a pair of Peacemakers. Men in every saloon know your face, and half of them want to test it. You cover the fear with jokes and the jokes with gunsmoke. Something about you seems to draw death — and lately, not just toward your enemies.

AT THE TABLE

Pure gunfighter. **Two-Gun Kid** plus **Ambidextrous** let you fire both Peacemakers each round without the usual penalties — the highest sustained pistol damage at Novice. **Marksman** gives a free Aim bonus if you don't move, **Steady Hands** shoots cleanly from horseback, and **Duelist** stacks the deck in the Deadlands dueling rules. Taunt d8 with **Gallows Humor** means you can crack a joke to rattle enemies and even shrug off fear. The cost: **Grim Servant O' Death** adds +1 damage but when you roll badly you may hit a friend, Strength d4 means you can't carry much, and Toughness 5 is thin.

> **Pick this if** You want to be the iconic Western hero and deal the most bullets per round. Glass cannon with a sense of humor.

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d8	d8	d6	d4	d6

Parry 5 **Toughness** 5 **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS

Shooting d8, Taunt d8

Athletics d6, Fighting d6, Notice d6

EDGES

Ambidextrous, Duelist, Gallows Humor, Marksman, Steady Hands, Two-Gun Kid

HINDRANCES

Grim Servant O' Death (Major), Overconfident (Major)

WEAPONS & GEAR

Colt Peacemaker 2d6+1 (x2), Knife Str+d4, Speed-load cylinder, Fancy gun belt



GUNHAND

Vaquero

Rider and all-around fighter

"You've herded cattle across the whole Southwest and seen things you can't explain. You keep riding."

A horseman first and everything else second, you learned your trade on the great Mexican and Texan ranches. You're loyal to a fault, quick with a rope and a gun, and your eyes give away what your mouth won't.

AT THE TABLE

A strong melee-and-ranged fighter. Fighting d8 and Shooting d8 with Parry 6 and Toughness 6 — the best combat baseline of the non-caster all-rounders. **Fan the Hammer** empties your Peacemaker's cylinder in a single action for a devastating burst, **Trademark Weapon** adds +1 to hit with your chosen gun, **Steady Hands** shoots cleanly from horseback, and **Born in the Saddle** gives Riding rerolls. The lariat entangles. **Lyin' Eyes** hurts your Persuasion and Intimidation when you're bluffing.

> **Pick this if** You want to fight well at every range, have a horse that matters, and play the loyal heart of the posse.

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d8	d6	d6	d6	d8

Parry 6 **Toughness** 6 **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS

Fighting d8, Shooting d8
Athletics d6, Language (English) d6, Notice d6, Riding d6

EDGES

Born in the Saddle, Fan the Hammer, Steady Hands, Trademark Weapon

HINDRANCES

Heroic (Major), Loyal (Minor), Lyin' Eyes (Minor)

WEAPONS & GEAR

Colt Peacemaker 2d6+1, Winchester '76 2d8, Lariat, Knife Str+d4, Chaps, Horse, Rope, bedroll, canteen



ARCANE

Hexslinger

Arcane gunfighter

"Doc Holliday taught the West that a bullet can carry a hex. You learned."

A huckster who found a better use for Hoyle's codes: casting through the barrel of a gun. Your Winchester and Colt are etched with runes, your bullets do things bullets shouldn't, and you are very, very sure of yourself. Arrogance and curiosity got you here. They'll probably get you killed too.

AT THE TABLE

Ranged damage with magical support on the same action economy. Shooting d8 and Spellcasting d8; **Hexslinging** lets you cast hexes through your guns, and **Ammo Whammy** enchants your bullets with extra effects. **Deflection** and **Protection** harden you, **Boost/Lower Trait** buffs, **Confusion** and **Numb** debilitate. **Calculating** ignores up to 2 points of penalties when your Action Card is 5 or lower. Like all hucksters you can Deal with the Devil for more power at real risk. Parry 4 and Toughness 5 — you're a back-rank shooter.

> **Pick this if** You want to shoot things with magic bullets and be the flashy, cocky one. Gunslinger with a spellbook.

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d6	d8	d8	d6	d6

Parry 4 **Toughness** 5 **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS

Shooting d8, Spellcasting d8
Athletics d6, Common Knowledge d6, Gambling d6, Notice d6, Riding d6

EDGES

Arcane Background (Huckster), Calculating, Hexslinging

HINDRANCES

Arrogant (Major), Curious (Major)

POWERS

Ammo Whammy, Boost/Lower Trait, Confusion, Deflection, Numb, Protection

WEAPONS & GEAR

Rune-etched Winchester '73 2d8-1, Rune-etched Colt Frontier 2d6+1, Bullet-making kit, Doc Holliday dime novel



ARCANE

Huckster

Card-sharp spellslinger

"Every hex is a hand of poker played against a demon. You usually win."

Hoyle's Book of Games hides a cipher, and you cracked it. Now you cast 'hexes' by gambling with manitous for their power — a high-stakes game where losing means Backlash or worse. You dress well, talk fast, cheat gracefully, and lately you don't sleep much. The things you've dealt with come visiting at night.

AT THE TABLE

The posse's wizard. Spellcasting d8 powers **Bolt** (your main ranged damage, at range and with raises for extra dice), **Boost/Lower Trait**, and **Trinkets** for conjuring small useful objects. **High Roller** and **Card Sharp** both improve your odds when you Deal with the Devil to supercharge a hex. Gambling d8 and Taunt d6 make you dangerous at the table and in a war of words. Fragile: Toughness 5, Parry 4, and a derringer. **Night Terrors (Major)** and **Trouble Magnet** keep life interesting.

> **Pick this if** You want to play the clever, risk-taking caster whose magic is literally a gamble.

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d6	d8	d8	d6	d6

Parry 4 **Toughness** 5 **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS
Gambling d8, Spellcasting d8
Common Knowledge d6, Notice d6, Persuasion d6, Stealth d6, Taunt d6

EDGES
Arcane Background (Huckster), Card Sharp, High Roller

HINDRANCES
Night Terrors (Major), Quirk (Minor), Trouble Magnet (Minor)

POWERS
Bolt, Boost/Lower Trait, Trinkets

WEAPONS & GEAR
Derringer 2d4, Knife Str+d4, Playing cards, Hoyle's Book of Games, Wrist holster for extra cards



ARCANE

Mad Scientist

Gadgeteer and inventor

"They laughed at you at the academy. They aren't laughing now. They're running."

Ghost rock burns hot and whispers, and you've learned to listen. Your infernal devices do the impossible — electrical death rays, curative salves, shrinking apparatus — but they malfunction at the worst times and the whispers are getting louder. You're brilliant. You're also not entirely well.

AT THE TABLE

A caster whose powers are gadgets. Weird Science d8 runs four devices: an **Electrostatic Emitter** (ranged damage), a **Curative Salve** (healing), a **Neural Overload Atomizer** (disabling), and a **Reductive Apparatus** (shrinking). Each has its own power points and can be handed to a friend, which no other caster can do. **True Genius** lets you reroll Weird Science by spending a Benny. Repair d8 and Science d8 fix anything. Toughness 7 thanks to the armored apron, but Parry 2 and Strength d4 — never let anyone reach you. Four Minor Hindrances (Bad Eyes, Delusional, Quirk, Shamed) give you a lot of personality.

> **Pick this if** You want to solve problems with inventions, hand your friends gadgets, and roleplay a genius who's slowly coming apart.

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d6	d8	d6	d4	d6

Parry 2 **Toughness** 7 (2) **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS
Common Knowledge d8, Repair d8, Science d8, Weird Science d8
Academics d6, Notice d6

EDGES
Arcane Background (Mad Scientist), True Genius

HINDRANCES
Bad Eyes (Minor), Delusional (Minor), Quirk (Minor), Shamed (Minor)

POWERS
Marvelous Spiral Electrostatic Emitter, All-Well Curative Salve, Neural Overload Atomizer, Reliably Reversible Reductive Apparatus

WEAPONS & GEAR
Knife Str+d4, Inventor's apron (armor), Lab coat, Notebooks, Various gadgets



ARCANE

Metal Mage

Occult engineer and blaster

"Call it science if it comforts you. The whispers in the machine know better."

Where a Mad Scientist thinks the ghost-rock whispers are inspiration, you know they're spirits — and you've made a deal with them. Your devices are as much sorcery as engineering, and they hit like artillery. From the Weird West Companion.

AT THE TABLE

The posse's area-damage specialist. **Blast** drops a damaging template on a group, **Havoc** throws enemies around and knocks them down, and the **Static Electric Whirlwind Gun** is a built-in ranged weapon; **Tool Bag** conjures the right tool for a job. Weird Science d8 and Repair d8, with the **Metal Mage** Edge changing how your devices draw power. Occult d6 and Research d6 make you a passable investigator of the supernatural. Parry 4, Toughness 5 — stay back and blow things up. **Arrogant** and **Night Terrors** as Majors.

> **Pick this if** You want crowd control and explosions and don't mind a hero who has made a deal he doesn't fully understand.

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d6	d8	d6	d6	d6

Parry 4 **Toughness** 5 **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS

Repair d8, Weird Science d8
Notice d6, Occult d6, Persuasion d6, Research d6, Science d6

EDGES

Arcane Background (Mad Scientist), Metal Mage

HINDRANCES

Arrogant (Major), Night Terrors (Major)

POWERS

Blast, Havoc, Static Electric Whirlwind Gun, Tool Bag

WEAPONS & GEAR

Wesson Dagger-Pistol 2d4, Tool kit, Smith & Robards catalog



ARCANE

Shaman

Spirit warrior and protector

"The Hunting Grounds have turned terrible. You fight to mend the veil."

You speak with the spirits of the land and they fight beside you. Where the Medicine Woman heals, you protect and strike: you ward your companions, bless their weapons, and lead the charge against the things crawling out of the broken spirit world. Settlers call you a witch doctor. You've stopped correcting them.

AT THE TABLE

A melee-capable support caster. Faith d8 runs **Protection** (armor for allies), **Smite** (weapon damage boost), **Boost/Lower Trait**, and **Wilderness Walk** (fast travel through rough country). **Holy Warrior** lets you spend power points to repel or damage supernaturally evil creatures around you. **Spirit's Favor** improves your casting. Parry 7 is second-best in the book, and Intimidation d8 lets you break enemies' nerve. Tomahawk only — no gun. **Old Ways Oath** means you refuse to use the settlers' technology.

> **Pick this if** You want a caster who stands near the front, buffs the fighters, and burns evil spirits.

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d6	d6	d8	d6	d6

Parry 7 **Toughness** 5 **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS

Faith d8, Intimidation d8
Athletics d6, Fighting d6, Healing d6, Notice d6, Riding d6

EDGES

Arcane Background (Shaman), Holy Warrior, Spirit's Favor

HINDRANCES

Heroic (Major), Old Ways Oath (Minor), Outsider (Minor)

POWERS

Boost/Lower Trait, Protection, Smite, Wilderness Walk

WEAPONS & GEAR

Tomahawk Str+d6, Horse, Bedroll



ARCANE

Witch

Hexes, charm, and area damage

"You'd be surprised how many problems a little abracadabra solves."

Not a huckster, not a shaman: your craft comes from older traditions carried across the ocean and down through the generations. You have a familiar, a black duster, a horse, and a vow you take seriously. The town you came from would still burn you for what you are. From the Weird West Companion.

AT THE TABLE

The most flexible caster in the book. Spellcasting d8 runs **Blast** (area damage), **Confusion** (disable groups), **Beguile** (charm), **Empathy** (read people and improve social rolls), and **Warrior's Gift** (grant a friend a combat Edge). That's damage, control, and buffing in one hero. **Familiar** gives you a spirit animal with its own uses; **Wichita Witch** is your tradition's special Edge. Occult d8 makes you the posse's expert on the supernatural. Fighting d6, Shooting d6, and a Colt Thunderer mean you're not helpless without power points. Parry 5, Toughness 5.

> **Pick this if** You want a toolbox of spells, a spirit companion, and a hero with a secret the world wouldn't forgive.

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d6	d8	d8	d4	d6

Parry 5 **Toughness** 5 **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS

Occult d8, Spellcasting d8

Fighting d6, Intimidation d6, Notice d6, Shooting d6

EDGES

Arcane Background (Witch), Familiar, Wichita Witch

HINDRANCES

Vow (Major), Loyal (Minor), Shamed (Minor)

POWERS

Beguile, Blast, Confusion, Empathy, Warrior's Gift

WEAPONS & GEAR

Colt Thunderer 2d6, Whip Str+d4, Black duster, Horse



HEALER

Blessed

Holy healer and protector

"A higher power works through you. Keep your soul clean and it always will."

Preacher, nun, circuit rider, or simply someone who prayed and was answered: the Blessed carry genuine miracles into a land that badly needs them. Your power is tied to your conduct — stray from your faith's teachings and it fades — which makes you the posse's conscience as much as its medic.

AT THE TABLE

The posse's primary healer and buffer. Faith d8 drives five powers: **Healing** patches Wounds, **Relief** clears Shaken and Fatigue, **Boost/Lower Trait** pumps a friend's die type, **Smite** adds holy damage to a weapon, and **Holy Symbol** wards off evil. **Champion** gives +2 damage and +2 Toughness against supernaturally evil creatures, so you're surprisingly solid against exactly the things Deadlands throws at you. Persuasion and Intimidation at d8 make you a capable talker too. The **Pacifist (Minor)** Hindrance means you fight only in defense — play it.

> **Pick this if** You like keeping the group alive, having a moral stance that matters, and being the one monsters fear.

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d6	d6	d8	d6	d6

Parry 5 **Toughness** 5 **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS

Faith d8, Intimidation d8, Persuasion d8

Common Knowledge d6, Fighting d6, Healing d6, Notice d6, Shooting d6

EDGES

Arcane Background (Blessed), Bolster, Champion

HINDRANCES

Heroic (Major), Loyal (Minor), Pacifist (Minor)

POWERS

Boost/Lower Trait, Healing, Holy Symbol, Relief, Smite

WEAPONS & GEAR

Colt Peacemaker 2d6+1, Hickory Stick Str+d4, Bible, Holy Cross and Vestments



HEALER

Medicine Woman

Spirit healer and voice of reason

"The spirits grant you power to mend and to cloud the senses. Use it well."

You walk the old ways while the world remakes itself with ghost rock and steel. The spirits answer you; you heal the sick, calm the frightened, and speak for your people to anyone who will listen. You carry little, because you need little — except the sacred objects without which the spirits fall silent.

AT THE TABLE

Healer and diplomat in one. Faith d8 drives **Healing** and **Relief** (wounds and fatigue), plus **Confusion** to disrupt enemies and **Deflection** to protect yourself. Persuasion d8 with **Tale-Teller** makes you a strong social lead, and **Brave** helps against fear. **Fetish** boosts your spirit-casting. The **Talisman (Major)** Hindrance means you cannot cast without your sacred items — lose them and you're a knife-wielding bystander. Strength d4, Toughness 5: stay behind the warriors.

> **Pick this if** You want to heal and talk rather than shoot, and you like a hero defined by her principles.

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d6	d6	d8	d4	d6

Parry 5 **Toughness** 5 **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS

Faith d8, Persuasion d8

Common Knowledge d6, Fighting d6, Healing d6, Notice d6, Survival d6

EDGES

Arcane Background (Shaman), Brave, Fetish, Tale-Teller

HINDRANCES

Talisman (Major), Old Ways Oath (Minor), Poverty (Minor)

POWERS

Confusion, Deflection, Healing, Relief

WEAPONS & GEAR

Knife Str+d4, Medicine bag, Bone necklace, Bedroll



HEALER

Sawbones

Frontier doctor and smart-mouth

"Nasty splinter. Gonna have to take the whole arm. Just kidding. Mostly."

You practise medicine in a place where the patients are shot, bitten, cursed, and occasionally already dead. You keep your hands steady with whiskey and your nerves with jokes, and you've seen enough to know what you don't understand. You're not a well man yourself, but you're the only doctor for a hundred miles.

AT THE TABLE

The non-magical healer. Healing d8 with the **Healer** Edge (+2 to Healing rolls) is as good as a Blessed's power at Novice and never runs out of power points. Taunt d8 with **Humiliate** (reroll Taunt) and **Gallows Humor** (Taunt against fear) makes you excellent at Tests in combat and at keeping the posse's spirits up. Fighting d6, Shooting d6, and a Colt Army mean you're not helpless. Smarts d8 and Spirit d8 are strong. **Ailin'** is a chronic illness that hurts your Vigor rolls; **Heavy Sleeper** is a liability on watch.

> **Pick this if** You want to be the healer without the religion, and you like a character who talks his way through fear.

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d6	d8	d8	d6	d6

Parry 5 **Toughness** 5 **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS

Healing d8, Taunt d8

Common Knowledge d6, Fighting d6, Notice d6, Shooting d6, Stealth d6

EDGES

Gallows Humor, Healer, Humiliate

HINDRANCES

Heroic (Major), Ailin' (Minor), Heavy Sleeper (Minor)

WEAPONS & GEAR

Colt Army 2d6+1, Knife Str+d4, Doctor's bag, Liquid courage, Tactile desensitizer



HEALER

Voodooist

Spirit-channeling support

"You need some hoodoo? You might know a spirit or two."

The loa answer you from the Louisiana bayous and beyond. Through them you heal, protect, and when it comes to it, unleash a fury that terrifies. You carry a talisman that is the key to all of it, and you are braver than the people who fear you.

AT THE TABLE

A healer with a frightening side. Faith d8 runs **Healing**, **Boost/Lower Trait**, **Aspect of the Rada Loa** (protective blessings), and **Fury of the Petro Loa** (offensive spirit power). **Favored** improves your relationship with the loa. Intimidation d8 and Occult d6 mean you're the one who recognises a curse and scares the culprit. **Talisman (Major)**: lose your talisman and your powers go with it. Strength d4, Toughness 5, knife only — a support hero who needs protecting.

> **Pick this if** You want a healer with menace and mystery, and you like your magic flavored by the bayou rather than the pulpit.

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d6	d6	d8	d4	d6

Parry 4 **Toughness** 5 **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS

Faith d8, Intimidation d8

Athletics d6, Common Knowledge d6, Healing d6, Notice d6, Occult d6, Taunt d6

EDGES

Arcane Background (Voodooist), Brave, Favored

HINDRANCES

Heroic (Major), Talisman (Major)

POWERS

Aspect of the Rada Loa, Boost/Lower Trait, Fury of the Petro Loa, Healing

WEAPONS & GEAR

Knife Str+d4, Talisman, Voodoo paraphernalia



FACE

Muckraker

Journalist and investigator

"If it isn't in print, it didn't happen. You intend to print all of it."

Newspapers are the only thing spreading faster than the railroad, and you write for one of them. You chase stories the Agency and the Rangers would rather bury, you talk your way into places you shouldn't be, and you carry a camera and a LeMat revolver because sometimes the story shoots back.

AT THE TABLE

A social and investigative lead. Persuasion d8 and Research d8 with **Investigator** (bonus to Research and to Notice for finding clues), **Alertness** (+2 Notice), and **Tale-Teller** (your stories give the whole posse Bennies). **Guts** keeps you steady when the monster shows. Taunt d6 lets you needle enemies in a fight. The LeMat is a nine-shot revolver with an underbarrel shotgun — a surprising amount of gun for a reporter. Vigor d4 and Toughness 4 make you the frailest hero in the book; one good hit will drop you.

> **Pick this if** You want to be the one asking questions and getting the posse into trouble, and you accept that you'll hide behind the Ranger when the shooting starts.

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d6	d8	d6	d6	d4

Parry 4 **Toughness** 4 **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS

Persuasion d8, Research d8

Common Knowledge d6, Notice d6, Shooting d6, Stealth d6, Taunt d6, Trade (Journalism) d6

EDGES

Alertness, Guts, Investigator, Tale-Teller

HINDRANCES

Curious (Major), Big Mouth (Minor), Stubborn (Minor)

WEAPONS & GEAR

LeMat Revolver w/ underbarrel shotgun 2d6, Camera and plates, Journal, Satchel



FACE

Saloon Gal

Charmer and information broker

"A piano player, a couple of hours, and you'll know every secret this town has buried."

Singer, hostess, card dealer, confidante: you run the room. Men tell you things they'd never tell the sheriff, and you remember all of it. You keep a derringer in your garter and a lot of favors owed, and you have more nerve than most of the gunhands who drink at your bar.

AT THE TABLE

The posse's social engine. Persuasion d8, Performance d8, Taunt d6, with **Attractive** (+1 to Persuasion and Performance), **Streetwise** for finding information and contacts, **Retort** to turn an enemy's Taunt or Intimidation back on them, and **Tale-Teller** to earn Bennies for the whole group. **Brave** adds +2 against fear — you've seen it all. In a fight you Taunt to set enemies up for your friends; your derringer is a last resort. Strength d4, Parry 4, Toughness 5: do not be in melee.

> **Pick this if** You want to win scenes with words, run the posse's network of contacts, and be braver than you look.

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d6	d8	d8	d4	d6

Parry 4 **Toughness** 5 **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS

Performance d8, Persuasion d8
Athletics d6, Common Knowledge d6, Notice d6, Taunt d6

EDGES

Attractive, Brave, Retort, Streetwise, Tale-Teller

HINDRANCES

Curious (Major), Heroic (Major)

WEAPONS & GEAR

Derringer 2d4, Nice dresses with matching shoes



SCOUT

Explorer

Wilderness guide and scholar

"Vast parts of the West are still blank on the map. You intend to fill them in."

Educated, well-travelled, and perhaps a little past your prime, you came west for the Explorer's Society or for your own insatiable curiosity. You know how to live off the land, read the sky, and recognise the thing in the canyon from a woodcut in a book nobody else has read.

AT THE TABLE

The posse's navigator and knowledge base. Notice d8, Survival d8, and Common Knowledge d8 are the best in the book, backed by Smarts d8 and Spirit d8. **Woodsman** and **Scout** make you nearly impossible to ambush outdoors and keep the posse fed and on course; **Strong Willed** resists Tests; **Elan** gives +2 whenever you spend a Benny on a roll; **Reliable** helps you Support allies. **Elderly (Major)** is the trade-off: lower Pace and Strength/Vigor dice, in exchange for the extra skill points that make you this competent. Parry 4 — stay out of melee.

> **Pick this if** You like being the one who knows things and keeps the group alive between the gunfights, and you don't mind a slower hero.

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d6	d8	d8	d6	d6

Parry 4 **Toughness** 5 **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS

Common Knowledge d8, Notice d8, Survival d8
Academics d6, Persuasion d6, Shooting d6, Stealth d6

EDGES

Elan, Reliable, Scout, Strong Willed, Woodsman

HINDRANCES

Curious (Major), Elderly (Major)

WEAPONS & GEAR

Springfield Rifled Musket 2d8, Knife Str+d4, Monocle, Magnifying glass, Hunting clothes



SCOUT

Native Scout

Tracker and sharpshooter

"Your people taught you the land. The land is teaching you what's wrong with it."

You move between two worlds — your tribe's and the settlers' — and belong fully to neither. What you do belong to is the country itself: you can read a trail a week old, vanish in open ground, and put a rifle round where it needs to go. The Reckoning twists the wild places first, and you're the first to see it.

AT THE TABLE

The best recon character in the book. Notice d8, Stealth d8, Survival d8, Shooting d8, with **Woodsman** (+2 to Survival and Stealth in the wild) and **Scout** (you spot ambushes and dangers first). **Free Runner** lets you move at full Pace across rough ground and climb without penalty. Agility d8 and Smarts d8 make you sharp in both senses. Strength d4 and Toughness 5 mean you kill from range and avoid the brawl. **Heroic (Major)** means you'll help anyone in real need — which is how you end up in the posse.

> **Pick this if** You want to scout ahead, set up the ambush instead of walking into it, and shoot from cover.

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d8	d8	d6	d4	d6

Parry 5 **Toughness** 5 **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS

Notice d8, Shooting d8, Stealth d8, Survival d8

Athletics d6, Fighting d6, Language (English) d6, Riding d6

EDGES

Free Runner, Scout, Woodsman

HINDRANCES

Heroic (Major), Mean (Minor), Trouble Magnet (Minor)

WEAPONS & GEAR

Winchester '73 2d8-1, Knife Str+d4, Pony, Bedroll



BRAINS

Agent

Monster-hunting detective

"The government knows about the things in the dark. You're the one it sends."

The Agency is the United States' quiet answer to the Reckoning: badge-carrying investigators who track down abominations, cover up what the public can't handle, and shoot what won't be covered up. You work alone or with a posse, you ask questions nobody wants asked, and you've seen enough to know the answers are usually worse than the rumor.

AT THE TABLE

A true hybrid. Fighting d8 and Shooting d8 make the Agent a real combatant, and the Gatling Pistol with **Rock and Roll!** means you can hose a target with automatic fire without the usual recoil penalty. Off the battlefield, Research d8 plus the **Investigator** Edge make you the posse's best lead-finder, and Occult d6 means you actually know what you're hunting. **Guts** helps you keep your head when the horror shows up. Weak spot: Strength d4 and Toughness 5 — you are not built to take hits.

> **Pick this if** You want to drive the mystery forward and still hold your own in a gunfight. Think Pinkerton meets The X-Files.

AGI	SMA	SPI	STR	VIG
d8	d8	d6	d4	d6

Parry 6 **Toughness** 5 **Pace** 6

BEST SKILLS

Fighting d8, Research d8, Shooting d8

Intimidation d6, Notice d6, Occult d6, Persuasion d6

EDGES

Agent, Guts, Investigator, Rock and Roll!

HINDRANCES

Curious (Major), Driven (Major)

WEAPONS & GEAR

Colt Rainmaker 2d6, Gatling Pistol 2d6, Knife Str+d4, Disguise kit, Agency Badge

Picking in five minutes

Want to be in the thick of it? Warrior (melee), Territorial Ranger (armor and shotgun), Harrowed (can't die, already did), Chi Master (dodge and punch), Vaquero or Cowgirl (fight and ride).

Want to shoot things? Gunslinger (two pistols, most bullets), Bounty Hunter (one rifle, biggest hits), Hexslinger (magic bullets), Native Scout (from cover, unseen).

Want to cast? Huckster (wizard who gambles for power), Witch (the widest spell list), Metal Mage (explosions), Mad Scientist (gadgets you can share), Shaman (buff the fighters and burn evil).

Want to keep everyone alive? Blessed (miracles plus holy damage), Sawbones (medicine and jokes), Medicine Woman (healing and diplomacy), Voodooist (healing with menace).

Want to talk? Saloon Gal (runs the room), Muckraker (asks the dangerous questions), Agent (asks them with a badge and a Gatling pistol), Explorer (knows the answer already).

Then: tell your Marshal which one. A copy with all the Edges, gear, and powers already on the sheet will be waiting in Foundry under *Archetypes → Deadlands Archetypes*. Rename it, pick a portrait, and write two sentences about who they were before the posse. That's your character.

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